

Government initiatives and falling prices driving India's LED lighting market

According to a report titled 'India LED Lighting Market (2017-2023)' by 6Wresearch, India's LED lighting market is projected to grow at a CAGR of 26.6 per cent during 2017-23. India's LED lighting market is projected to witness robust growth owing to government initiatives such as UJALA, Housing for All and Deendayal Upadhyaya Gram Jyoti Yojna. Further, missions like Smart Cities would also drive the LED lighting market in the coming years.

Ravi Bhandari, assistant manager - research and consulting, 6Wresearch, says, "Streetlight LEDs hold the major share in the overall LED lighting market and are expected to dominate the market in the forecast period. The government of India, under Street Light

National Programme, has to replace 35 million conventional streetlights with LED lights by March 2019, thus increasing the demand for LED bulbs in streetlight applications.

"Further, demand for LED downlighters has also increased due to growing adoption in the areas of hospitality, retail, educational institutions, commercial offices and others.

"Profit margins of the market players have decreased due to growing competition and entry of new players in the country in the last few years. And, the government is encouraging domestic manufacturing, which would further lead to price competition in the industry," adds Kanika Sharma, research associate - research and consulting, 6Wresearch.

IIoT connections to surge to 66 million global connections in 2017

Though industrial manufacturers are lagging in their adoption of Cloud based services and connecting their legacy systems to digital networks, vision for a vast Internet of Things (IIoT) market is starting to take shape. Industrial manufacturing applications will generate more than US\$ 138 million in 2017 from mobile and satellite connectivity fees, forecasts ABI Research. The industrial IIoT (IIoT) market will add more than 13 million new wireline and wireless connections worldwide in 2017 to an installed base exceeding 53 million connections.

"Costs for data storage and compute processing has dropped significantly in the past few years, making the digitisation of industrial equipment

now possible for nearly every manufacturing business," says Jeff Orr, research director at ABI Research. "New applications are possible, including predictive analytics, digital twin simulation modelling and gaining insight that enable new business models and sources of revenue," he adds.

Asia-Pacific region has the largest concentration of new IIoT connections with more than five million additional expected in 2017. Global opportunity will continue to grow over the next four years with a forecast of 18 million new IIoT connections annually by 2021, though some compression is expected for connection-related revenues, which will decline to US\$ 122 million in 2021.

On The Move

Snapdeal names Jason Kothari as FreeCharge CEO

Jason Kothari, chief strategy and investment officer of Snapdeal, has taken over as chief executive officer of FreeCharge, the digital payments platform owned by the online marketplace.

Rejig at Samsung Mobiles

Samsung has rejigged the roles of senior executives for its mobile phone business to effectively counter Chinese competition.

Mohandeep Singh has been promoted as senior vice president for the mobile phone business where he is in charge of sales and retail marketing, and is responsible for all major operations for the business.

Asim Warsi has been brought back to the mobile phone arm after he was given the responsibility to create the online product portfolio and product plans for all categories last year. Warsi, a senior vice president, will now head the mobile business product marketing team that plans all new launches and activations around it.

Manu Sharma, who was vice president - product marketing at Samsung's mobile business, will head sales for north and east.

Ericsson appoints Nunzio Mirtello as India market head

Swedish telecom gear maker Ericsson has appointed Nunzio Mirtello as head of market for South East Asia, Oceania and India.

Lenovo India appoints Vivek Sharma as director - data centre business

Lenovo India has appointed Vivek Sharma as the company's new director, Data Centre Group, India. He will be based in Bengaluru, and will report to Sumir Bhatia, vice president, Data Centre Group, Asia-Pacific, Lenovo. Sharma will also be part of Lenovo's India Leadership Team, which is led by India managing director and chief executive officer, Rahul Agarwal.